FARZANEH SABBAGH

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of New Hampshire, Durham, NH *2022 – expected May 2027*
Dissertation: *Environmental Quality, Demographic Composition, and Community Investment: Essays on Local Public Goods*
Committee: Robert Mohr and Stephanie Brockmann (co-chairs), Karen Conway, Scott Lemos, Qingran Li

M.Sc. in Quantitative Economics, Bielefeld University, Bielefeld, Germany *2018 – 2022*
Thesis: *Public Debt and Economic Growth in European Economies*

B.Sc. in Economics, University of Tehran, Tehran, Iran *2012 – 2016*

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary: Environmental and natural resource economics, non-market valuation, applied econometrics

Secondary: Public economics and local public finance, school finance, international trade and open economy

Teaching fields: Principles and intermediate microeconomics, econometrics, environmental and natural resource economics, public economics, cost-benefit analysis, data analytics, international economics

RESEARCH AND PRESENTATIONS

Publication

Mohr, R., & **Sabbagh, F.** (2026). National Priorities List. In D. E. Taylor (Ed.), *The Sage Encyclopedia of Environmental Justice* (Vol. 3, pp. 875–880). SAGE Publications. https://doi.org/10.4135/9781071908006.n265

This entry reviews the National Priorities List (NPL), the roster of the most hazardous waste sites in the United States designated for long-term cleanup under the Superfund program. We describe how sites are listed and remediated, synthesize the evidence on the racial and socioeconomic disparities linked to site location and cleanup duration, and review what is known about the health, property-value, and gentrification effects of remediation on nearby communities.

Job Market Paper

"Are Nutrient Policy Impacts on Recreation in Lake Erie as Murky as the Water?" (with S. Brockmann)
Supported by an external research grant from the Great Lakes Fishery Commission (2023 – 2027)

Harmful algal blooms have re-emerged as the central management challenge on Lake Erie, prompting the United States and Canada to commit to a 40% cut in the phosphorus loading that feeds them. This paper asks how that cut affects two different groups of recreational users: beachgoers, whose visits depend on water conditions, and anglers, whose visits depend on the fishery that those same nutrients help sustain. To measure how each group values the policy, I designed and administered two contingent-behavior surveys that record respondents' actual trips to the lake alongside the trips they say they would take under hypothetical scenarios varying bloom severity, water safety, and fish populations. Using the travel cost method, I estimate negative binomial recreation demand models in which each respondent's actual and hypothetical trips are pooled in a single estimation. I then feed simulations from a calibrated ecosystem model of the lake into these demand functions; to my knowledge, no earlier study runs an ecosystem model's policy simulations through a pooled demand model for two user groups. Beachgoers respond to bloom severity with a threshold: moderate and severe blooms deter visits almost equally, so beach-trip gains are modest under the 40% target and grow sharply only under deeper reductions that restore mild conditions. Anglers, by contrast, respond to fish

abundance and water safety rather than bloom size. The paper quantifies the lake's documented water quality–fisheries tradeoff in economic terms, delivering the distributional evidence regulators need to compare nutrient targets on a common welfare footing.

Conference Presentations:

Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA) Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA *January 2025*
Eastern Economic Association (EEA) Annual Conference, New York, NY *February 2025*
Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL *November 2025*

Working Paper

"How Racial Composition Shapes Local Investment in Education: Voter–Student Demographic Mismatch and School Bond Elections in Texas" (with R. Mohr and K. Conway)

School bonds are the primary way American communities finance long-term educational investments, yet they are decided in elections by adult voters whose racial and ethnic composition differs from that of the K–12 students the funds are intended to serve. This paper asks whether that mismatch affects bond passage. We develop a model of voting behavior in which a voter's decision is influenced by both their own race or ethnicity and the racial and ethnic composition of the district's student population. The model yields a measure of racial fragmentation, the Hybrid Fragmentation Index (HFI) of Kurtz et al. (2024), which is highest when the voting-age population is least representative of the student population. We construct a district-year panel of Texas school bond elections that links each district's voting-age population to its enrolled students. In models with district and year fixed effects, greater voter–student mismatch, as measured by the HFI, significantly reduces the probability of bond passage. We also uncover a reversal overlooked in earlier studies: the effect of a district's over-65 population on bond passage is negative early in the sample but becomes significantly more positive over time, suggesting that racial and ethnic mismatch, rather than age itself, may be a key barrier to educational investment.

Conference Presentation:

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Houston, TX *(accepted)* *November 2026*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, University of New Hampshire *Fall 2026*

Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 402) — sole responsibility for syllabus design, lectures, assessment, and grading for 75 students.

Guest Lecturer, University of New Hampshire *Spring 2026*

AI Prompt Engineering for Economics — taught prompt design and systematic validation of AI-generated economic analysis.

Teaching Assistant, University of New Hampshire *2022 – 2026*

Graduate

Econometrics I lab (ECON 926) *Fall 2024*
Microeconomics II lab (ECON 977) *Spring 2024*

Undergraduate

Introduction to Econometrics lab (ECON 726) *Fall 2024*
Advanced Econometrics lab (ECON 727) *Spring 2026*
Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 402) *Spring 2025, Fall 2025*
Intermediate Microeconomics (ECON 605) *Fall 2023, Spring 2024*
Industrial Economics and Business Innovation (ECON 654) *Fall 2022*
Innovation in the Global Economy (ECON 655) *Spring 2023, Spring 2025*
International Economics (ECON 645) *Spring 2025*

REFEREE SERVICE

Peer Reviewer, *Utilities Policy* *February 2026*

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

Research Assistant. *2023 – 2027*

"Assessing Welfare of Nutrient Targets and Alternate Policies on Lake Erie's Ecosystem and Economy." Great Lakes Fishery Commission. With Stephanie Brockmann (PI), David Finnoff, Edward Rutherford, Doran Mason, Hongyan Zhang, Lou Cornicelli, and Rob Southwick. Awarded: $295,841.

UNH Summer Teaching Assistant Fellowship (competitive) *2025*

Graduate Assistantship, UNH *2022 – present*

German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) Scholarship, Bielefeld University, Germany *2021*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sustainability Intern, ProAmpac, Cincinnati, OH *Summer 2025*

Analyzed energy and emissions data across global operations to identify greenhouse-gas hotspots; built cost-effectiveness assessments of reduction pathways and presented recommendations to corporate leadership.

Business Analyst, UNH Center for Business Analytics, Durham, NH *Summer 2023*

Designed surveys and delivered quantitative analyses and reports for client-facing projects.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Programming and software skills:

- **R (expert), Stata (expert):** Data cleaning, data analysis, quantitative research methods, and causal inference
- **MATLAB (advanced):** Econometric modeling, statistical analysis, and predictive modeling
- **ArcGIS, QGIS, Excel VBA:** Spatial analysis, visualization, and analytical reporting
- **LaTeX, Qualtrics, Microsoft Office:** Technical documentation, reporting and presentations, survey design

Empirical skills: non-market valuation (travel cost, contingent behavior, joint Revealed Preference/Stated Preference approach), causal inference, panel and fixed-effects models, discrete-choice and count-data models, survey design, spatial analysis, feeding ecological model outputs into economic demand models, applied machine learning (random forests, decision trees, model evaluation)

Professional Certificates: Wealth Management Course — Envestnet Institute, USA (2025); GIS 101, UNH, USA (2024); Microsoft Office, Bielefeld University, Germany (2022)

Languages: English (fluent), Farsi (native), German (intermediate)

REFERENCES

Robert Mohr, Professor of Economics, University of New Hampshire — Robert.Mohr@unh.edu

Stephanie Brockmann, Assistant Professor and Rhodes Chair of International Business, Baker University — stephanie.brockmann@bakeru.edu

Karen Conway, Professor of Economics, University of New Hampshire — Karen.Conway@unh.edu